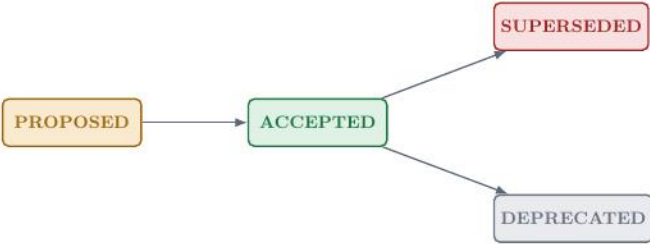


Architecture Decision Records

Nimbus Order Platform

Platform Engineering • Maintained by the Architecture Guild • Last reviewed 2025-06-02

Architecture Decision Records (ADRs) capture the significant, hard-to-reverse technical choices made while building the Nimbus order and fulfillment platform. Each record is immutable once accepted: if circumstances change, we write a new ADR that supersedes the old one rather than editing history. This register is the canonical index — consult it before proposing an approach that a past decision already ruled on.



Decision Register

ID	Title	Status	Date
ADR-0001	Record architecture decisions as lightweight ADRs	ACCEPTED	2024-11-04
ADR-0002	PostgreSQL as system of record for the order ledger	ACCEPTED	2024-11-18
ADR-0003	Kafka for asynchronous order-fulfillment events	ACCEPTED	2025-01-09
ADR-0004	Adopt gRPC for internal service-to-service calls	PROPOSED	2025-05-27
ADR-0005	Retire the legacy SOAP integration layer	SUPERSEDED	2024-09-12

ADR-0001 — Record Architecture Decisions as Lightweight ADRs

✔ Status

ACCEPTED

📅 Date

2024-11-04

👥 Deciders

M. Alvarez, R. Okonkwo, S. Bergstrom

🏷️ Tags

process, governance

🔗 Supersedes

—

🔗 Superseded by

—

📖 Context

The order-fulfillment rewrite has grown to nine services and four data stores maintained by three squads. Decisions about data ownership, messaging, and protocol choices were previously discussed in chat threads and design docs that were hard to find six months later. New engineers repeatedly re-opened debates ("why Postgres and not DynamoDB?") that had already been settled, and two squads independently built incompatible retry strategies because neither knew the other's reasoning. We need a durable, low-overhead record of significant technical decisions and the context behind them.

✔ Decision

We will record every architecturally significant decision as a short Markdown file under `/docs/adr/`, numbered sequentially (NNNN-title.md), following this five-part shape: *Status, Context, Decision, Consequences, Alternatives Considered*. Records are immutable once merged to `main`. A decision is superseded, never edited: a new ADR is written and the old one's status changes to **Superseded by ADR-NNNN**. Any change to a service boundary, data-ownership model, communication protocol, or a dependency that is expensive to reverse requires an ADR before implementation begins.